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2. The Evolution of Brics and the International System

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Introduction

Over the last several decades, international relations have remained in constant flux with shifting geostrategic priorities, domestic politics, regimes, and regional re-balances. Shifts in the global political systems had begun to create a renewed sense of the nation-state as early as the seventeenth century, after signing the Treaty of Westphalia in 1648. Henceforth, a more modern concept of the nation-state developed. This phenomenon is central to international relations and continues to be the basis for new world order. However, the current international relations (IR) system is very dynamic in it that it has been consistently changing through multiple features. It is essential to explore the changing realities of new emerging political trends. The regional and inter-regional groups are changing like the BRICS, SCO, EU, ASEAN, and several others. However, among all the groups, the BRICS has significance and stakes to claim due to its continental nature. Further, the BRICS has various resources essential to becoming the center of international relations.

The role of the BRICS is vital because of the BRICS population, GDP, land, world trade, and global forex. The BRICS countries have been cooperating in various areas. Presently, the BRICS sectoral cooperation accounts for more than 30 subject areas. The landmark incident took place in 2014 when the BRICS established a New Development Bank (NDB) and the Contingent Reserve